lief, which is a negation of the philosophical attitude and is, therefore, rightly left to the unphilosophical or the semi-philosophical drives of man's psychological makeup. This, incidentally, disposes of the charge often made against Indian philosophy that it has been responsible for India's political or material degradation. Philosophy cannot possibly play such a role, and, in fact, it has never done so, either in India or elsewhere in the world. To think thusly so, is not only to expect the impossible from philosophy but also to fundamentally misunderstand its nature and function. Neither the practical prosperity of the Western world nor its opposite in India or other underdeveloped countries of the world, is due to philosophy. The causes of the rise and fall of nations must be found in the unphilosophical part of their lives.

Another point that is very often made in connection with Indian philosophy is the emphasis on direct knowledge or the immediate intuition of the highest reality. It is said that the highest reality can be revealed to us only in an immediate intuition. In other words, while in Western philosophy stress is laid on rational knowledge, we seem to be certain that our intellect, reason, or logic is but a very imperfect instrument and is not, by nature, equal to the task of raising us to the highest attainable level. We have often heard it said that Indian philosophy is intuitive, and that in the end it leads us to mysticism. But this view, too, is not supported by one's study of comparative philosophy. There have been and still persist in the West such powerful and vigorous movements of the voluntaristic, the romantic, or the antiintellectualist systems of thought that every Indian student of comparative philosophy is almost as familiar with the foreign advocates of the intuitional way of knowing and living as he is with his own mystics in India. The same point of view is sometimes expressed a little differently by saying that Indian philosophy is more subjective than objective, or that it concerns itself more with the inner rather than with the outer reality. For a serious student of the subject, it is difficult, if not impossible, to find justification for such superficial characterization of Indian philosophy.

And now let us ask ourselves the question, what are the fundamental tenets of Indian philosophy, irrespective of consideration whether or not there is any philosophical justification for regarding them as fundamental to our philosophy? Here, I think, the very first idea that occurs to one is about the divine or the spiritual nature of the universe we live in. I think that it can perhaps be said truly that this has been one of the dominant beliefs of Indian thought, the belief that the universe is not either a haphazard